

WITCHES: COVEN DOCTRINES

WITCHES: COVEN DOCTRINES IS A MONSTER supplement for 5e that presents witches not as isolated spellcasters but as organized covens shaped by environment and doctrine. Rather than a single archetype, witches are presented as specialized magical traditions that arise wherever communities gather, wilderness deepens, or ancient places accumulate power.

The intent of this product is mechanical clarity and encounter variety without CR inflation. Each coven progresses through three ranks — Witch, Matron, and High Matron — representing increasing mastery of ritual magic and battlefield influence. These spellcasters are designed as intelligent controllers who reshape encounters through terrain, enchantment, fear, and preparation rather than raw damage output.

Cultural lore, motives, and internal politics are intentionally minimal. Whether these covens cooperate, compete, or despise one another is left to the GM. Some worlds may treat witches as hidden societies operating in secrecy, while others may see them as feared regional powers whose influence shapes entire territories. Use these stat blocks as tools. What binds these covens together — ancient pacts, shared magic, or simple ambition — is yours to decide.

THE FOREST COVEN

Forest covens draw their power from deep woodland and old growth wilderness. Their magic is rooted in creeping vines, ancient trees, and patient natural forces that overwhelm enemies through terrain control and gradual entanglement.

Forest encounters emphasize battlefield restriction and environmental pressure. These witches reshape the ground beneath their enemies with roots, thorns, and living growth, forcing intruders to fight through hostile terrain while curses and spells weaken them.

THE CITY COVEN

City covens flourish in crowded streets, shadowed alleys, and behind the facades of wealth and authority. Their magic spreads through whispers, illusions, and subtle manipulation rather than overt displays of power.

City encounters emphasize enchantment, deception, and control of social space. These witches dominate through charm magic, illusion, and strategic influence, often turning enemies against one another or isolating targets within dense urban environments.

THE SEA COVEN

Sea covens dwell along storm-wracked coastlines, hidden coves, and ancient shore temples where ocean magic gathers strength. Their rituals call upon tides, storms, and deep waters that answer only to those who understand their rhythms.

Sea encounters emphasize forced movement, lightning strikes, and terrain disruption. Waves crash, winds howl, and enemies find themselves pushed, pulled, or knocked prone as the witches manipulate both storm and sea.

THE MARSHLIGHT COVEN

Marshlight covens haunt bogs, wetlands, and drowned forests where ghostly lights drift above dark water. Their magic centers on deception, fear, and the eerie glow of corpse-lights that lure travelers away from safety.

Marshlight encounters emphasize illusion, fear effects, and battlefield confusion. Flickering lights obscure vision, spirits whisper in the fog, and enemies often struggle to determine what is real before curses and necrotic magic take hold.

THE DESERT COVEN

Desert covens command the harsh power of sun, wind, and endless sand. Their rituals draw upon scorching heat and shifting dunes, turning the environment itself into a relentless adversary.

Desert encounters emphasize attrition and battlefield reshaping through sandstorms, fire magic, and blinding winds. These witches exhaust their enemies, limiting movement and visibility until the desert itself becomes a weapon.

FOREST COVEN ROSTER

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Forest Coven Witch	5	Woodland spellcaster who commands roots, beasts, and creeping growth to control the battlefield.
Forest Coven Matron	7	Veteran coven leader who shapes forests into living weapons and binds enemies with ancient woodland curses.
Forest Coven High Matron	9	Ancient arboreal sorceress who awakens the forest itself to fight intruders.

CITY COVEN ROSTER

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
City Coven Witch	5	Urban spellcaster manipulating crowds, whispers, and political leverage to control encounters.
City Coven Matron	7	Influential coven leader who bends minds and social structures to weaken enemies before battle begins.
City Coven High Matron	9	Master conspirator whose magic spreads through the city like rumor and panic.

SEA COVEN ROSTER

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Sea Coven Witch	5	Tide-touched spellcaster who commands waves, currents, and drowning magic.
Sea Coven Matron	7	Stormcaller who lashes enemies with lightning and pulls them toward the sea.
Sea Coven High Matron	9	Oceanic archwitch whose presence bends storms and tides around the battlefield.

MARSHLIGHT COVEN ROSTER

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Marshlight Coven Witch	5	Bog sorceress who conjures corpse-lights and illusions that lure travelers to their doom.
Marshlight Coven Matron	7	Experienced marsh witch who manipulates fear, darkness, and flickering lights to mislead enemies.
Marshlight Coven High Matron	9	Haunting matriarch whose will-o'-wisp magic traps victims within ghostly marsh visions.

DESERT COVEN ROSTER

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Desert Coven Witch	5	Dune spellcaster wielding mirages, scorching winds, and blinding sand.
Desert Coven Matron	7	Sun-marked witch who drains strength through heat, thirst, and relentless desert magic.
Desert Coven High Matron	9	Ancient sand sorceress whose storms swallow enemies in burning dunes.

SEA WITCHES

SEA COVEN WITCH

Medium humanoid (any), any evil

Armor Class 15 (arcane ward)

Hit Points 95 (10d8 + 50)

Speed 30 ft., swim 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	14 (+2)	20 (+5)	16 (+3)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)

Saving Throws Con +8, Wis +5, Cha +6

Skills Arcana +6, Nature +6, Perception +5

Damage Resistances cold

Senses passive Perception 15

Languages Common plus two others

Challenge 5 (1,800 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +3

Amphibious. This witch can breathe air and water.

Coven Magic. When this witch is within 30 feet of another allied witch, both witches have advantage on Constitution saving throws made to maintain concentration on spells.

Tidecaller. While this witch is within 20 feet of a body of water, the area within 10 feet of it is difficult terrain for hostile creatures as waves and surging water interfere with movement.

Spellcasting. This witch is a 9th-level spellcaster. Its spellcasting ability is Charisma (spell save DC 14, +6 to hit with spell attacks). It requires no material components to cast its spells.

- **Cantrips (at will):** *mage hand*, *ray of frost*
- **1st level (4 slots):** *fog cloud*, *thunderwave*, *charm person*
- **2nd level (3 slots):** *hold person*, *misty step*
- **3rd level (3 slots):** *lightning bolt*
- **4th level (3 slots):** *control water*
- **5th level (1 slot):** *cone of cold*

ACTIONS

Staff. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 3 (1d6) bludgeoning damage.

- This witch attempts to fight near water where its terrain control becomes most effective.
- It opens with *fog cloud* or *tidal wave* to disrupt positioning.
- It relies on mobility and *misty step* to avoid being pinned down in melee.



MARSHLIGHT COVEN MATRON

Medium humanoid (any), any evil

Armor Class 16 (arcane ward)

Hit Points 127 (15d8 + 60)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	14 (+2)	18 (+4)	16 (+3)	16 (+3)	18 (+4)

Saving Throws Con +7, Wis +6, Cha +7

Skills Arcana +6, Deception +7, Perception +6, Stealth +6

Damage Resistances necrotic

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 16

Languages Common plus two others

Challenge 7 (2,900 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +3

Coven Magic. When this witch is within 30 feet of another allied witch, both witches have advantage on Constitution saving throws made to maintain concentration on spells.

Corpse-Light Veil. Ghostly lights swirl around this witch. Dim light within 30 feet of it becomes lightly obscured for hostile creatures. A hostile creature that starts its turn in this area must succeed on a DC 15 Wisdom saving throw or have disadvantage on the next attack roll it makes before the end of its turn.

Spellcasting. This witch is an 11th-level spellcaster. Its spellcasting ability is Charisma (spell save DC 15, +7 to hit with spell attacks). It requires no material components to cast its spells.

- **Cantrips (at will):** *chill touch, minor illusion, poison spray*
- **1st level (4 slots):** *charm person, disguise self, fog cloud*
- **2nd level (3 slots):** *hold person, mirror image*
- **3rd level (3 slots):** *bestow curse, fear*
- **4th level (3 slots):** *greater invisibility*
- **5th level (2 slots):** *mislead*
- **6th level (1 slot):** *circle of death*

ACTIONS

Staff. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 3 (1d6) bludgeoning damage.

- This witch weakens enemies with fear and illusion before committing to curses.
- It keeps enemies disoriented inside its corpse-light veil while maintaining concentration on control spells.
- It prefers to remain hidden behind terrain or allies while manipulating the battlefield.



DESERT COVEN HIGH MATRON

Medium humanoid (any), any evil

Armor Class 17 (arcane ward)

Hit Points 168 (16d8 + 96)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	14 (+2)	22 (+6)	18 (+4)	16 (+3)	20 (+5)

Saving Throws Con +10, Wis +7, Cha +9

Skills Arcana +8, Nature +8, Survival +7

Damage Resistances fire

Senses passive Perception 13

Languages Common plus two others

Challenge 9 (5,000 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +4

Coven Magic. When this witch is within 30 feet of another allied witch, both witches have advantage on Constitution saving throws made to maintain concentration on spells.

Desert Dominion. Scorching winds and blinding sand swirl around this witch. Hostile creatures within 30 feet of it treat the area as difficult terrain. A hostile creature that starts its turn in this area must succeed on a DC 16 Constitution saving throw or take 7 (2d6) fire damage and have disadvantage on the next attack roll it makes before the end of its turn.

Spellcasting. This witch is a 13th-level spellcaster. Its spellcasting ability is Charisma (spell save DC 17, +9 to hit with spell attacks). It requires no material components to cast its spells.

- **Cantrips (at will):** *fire bolt, mage hand, minor illusion*
- **1st level (4 slots):** *burning hands, charm person, fog cloud*
- **2nd level (3 slots):** *blur, scorching ray*
- **3rd level (3 slots):** *fireball, hypnotic pattern*
- **4th level (3 slots):** *wall of fire*
- **5th level (2 slots):** *flame strike*
- **6th level (1 slot):** *sunbeam*
- **7th level (1 slot):** *fire storm*

ACTIONS

Staff. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 4 (1d6 + 1) bludgeoning damage.

- This witch opens combat with large area spells like *fire storm* or *wall of fire* to divide the battlefield.
- It relies on desert terrain effects to slow enemies and force them through damaging areas.
- It avoids melee, preferring to maintain distance while controlling the battlefield with fire and sand.



LEGAL

This work includes material from the System Reference Document 5.1 © Wizards of the Coast LLC, available under the Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International License.

© 2026 MmpApps Corp. All rights reserved.

Except for material derived from the System Reference Document 5.1, all original content in this work is the exclusive property of MmpApps Corp. and is not licensed under the Creative Commons license. Text was formatted using [The Homebrewery](#).